CHRISCO Youth Aflame
CHRISCO DIGITAL ACADEMY | CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES

Print on Demand Course Handbook

"Sell custom-designed products worldwide, with zero inventory."



Design & Digital Commerce Track | 8 Weeks | Beginner

28-Page Illustrated Edition

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Course Foreword



Print on demand (POD) lets you sell t-shirts, mugs, posters and more without buying stock, printing anything, or shipping a single parcel. A platform prints and ships each item only after a customer orders. You supply the design and the marketing; they handle the rest.

This is one of the few online businesses where a beginner with a laptop and taste can compete globally. It is not free money, designs and marketing decide success, but the risk is tiny because you never pay for stock that might not sell.

THE PRACTITIONER PROMISE

You will choose a niche, create designs that sell, set up a store, write listings that get found, and market your way to passive product income without ever holding stock.

Treat it as a design-and-marketing business. The people who win create many designs, study what sells, and keep improving. Start simple, publish, and learn from real sales.

Published by CHRISCO Digital Academy under CHRISCO Youth Aflame (*CHRISCO Fellowship of Churches*), this 28-page course handbook explains every module clearly with visual diagrams, real East African case studies, and step-by-step labs. Reach our mentorship desk anytime at chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com.



Key Learning Outcomes

01

Introduction to print on demand: No stock, no shipping, the platform fulfils orders.

02

Design basics for POD: Simple, clever designs sell, artistry optional.

03

Creating listings that sell: Listings are your marketing, write for search.

04

Scaling your income: Launch with a solid batch, then keep adding.

Across 8 Weeks of structured practice, each of the 8 modules is given a dedicated two-page spread: first unpacking the concept visually, then walking through a real field scenario and hands-on lab.

By Module 08, you will have built and verified a complete merchandise storefront ready to serve employers, clients, ministries, and communities with excellence.

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01
Foundations & Core Mindset

Module 01: Introduction to print on demand | Module 02: Choosing your niche

MODULE 01 · PART 1

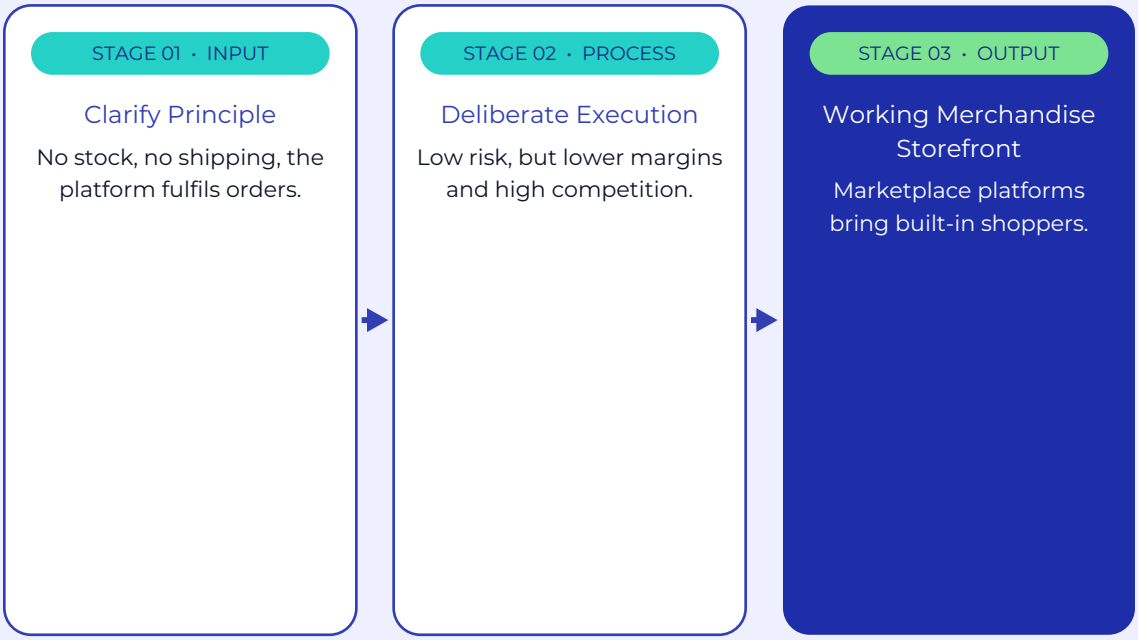
1.1 Introduction to print on demand

In POD, you upload a design, place it on products in an online catalogue, and list them for sale. When someone buys, the platform prints your design on the item and ships it directly to the customer. You keep the difference between the base cost and your selling price. No upfront stock, no storage, no shipping headaches.

The trade-off for this low risk is lower profit per item and heavy competition, so volume and good marketing matter. Some platforms (like Redbubble) also bring their own shoppers, which is perfect for beginners; others require you to drive all the traffic yourself. Understanding this model clearly is the first step to using it well.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *introduction to print on demand* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real merchandise storefront. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that no stock, no shipping, the platform fulfils orders., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.

VISUAL CONCEPT DIAGRAM · MODULE 01: INTRODUCTION TO PRINT ON DEMAND





MODULE 01 | WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A designer uploads one funny slogan design and places it on shirts, mugs and stickers. Over months, with no stock and no shipping on her side, those listings quietly sell to buyers around the world while she creates more.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Print on Demand workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 01

Your Practical Task: Browse a POD marketplace like Redbubble. Find three best-selling designs and note what they have in common (style, humour, niche, simplicity).

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 01 Key Takeaways

01

No stock, no shipping, the platform fulfils orders.

02

Low risk, but lower margins and high competition.

03

Marketplace platforms bring built-in shoppers.

MODULE 02 · PART 1

1.2 Choosing your niche

Generic designs get lost; niche designs get bought. A niche is a specific group with a shared identity or interest, nurses, cat lovers, gym-goers, a hobby, a profession, a hometown pride. People love wearing what says 'this is me,' and they search for exactly that. A tight niche makes both your designs and your marketing far easier.

Pick niches with passion and spending power, and ideally ones you understand, so your designs feel authentic rather than generic. You can serve several small niches over time. Avoid trademarked names, logos and slogans, using protected brands will get your account banned, so create original work around themes, not brands.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *choosing your niche* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real merchandise storefront. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that specific niches sell; generic designs get lost., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.



MODULE 02 | FIELD BRIEF

Focus Skill:
Choosing your niche

Core Rule:
Specific niches sell; generic designs get lost.

Target Output:
Working merchandise storefront

MODULE 02 | WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
'Funny t-shirt' is hopeless in search. 'Sarcastic nurse t-shirt' finds a passionate, specific buyer who feels seen, and happily pays. The narrower the identity, the easier the sale.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Print on Demand workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 02

Your Practical Task: List five niches you understand or belong to. For each, write one design idea that people in that group would proudly wear.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 02 Key Takeaways

01

Specific niches sell; generic designs get lost.

02

People buy designs that say 'this is me'.

03

Never use trademarked brands, originals only.



02
Core Frameworks & Strategy

Module 03: Design basics for POD | Module 04: Setting up on Redbubble

MODULE 03 · PART 1

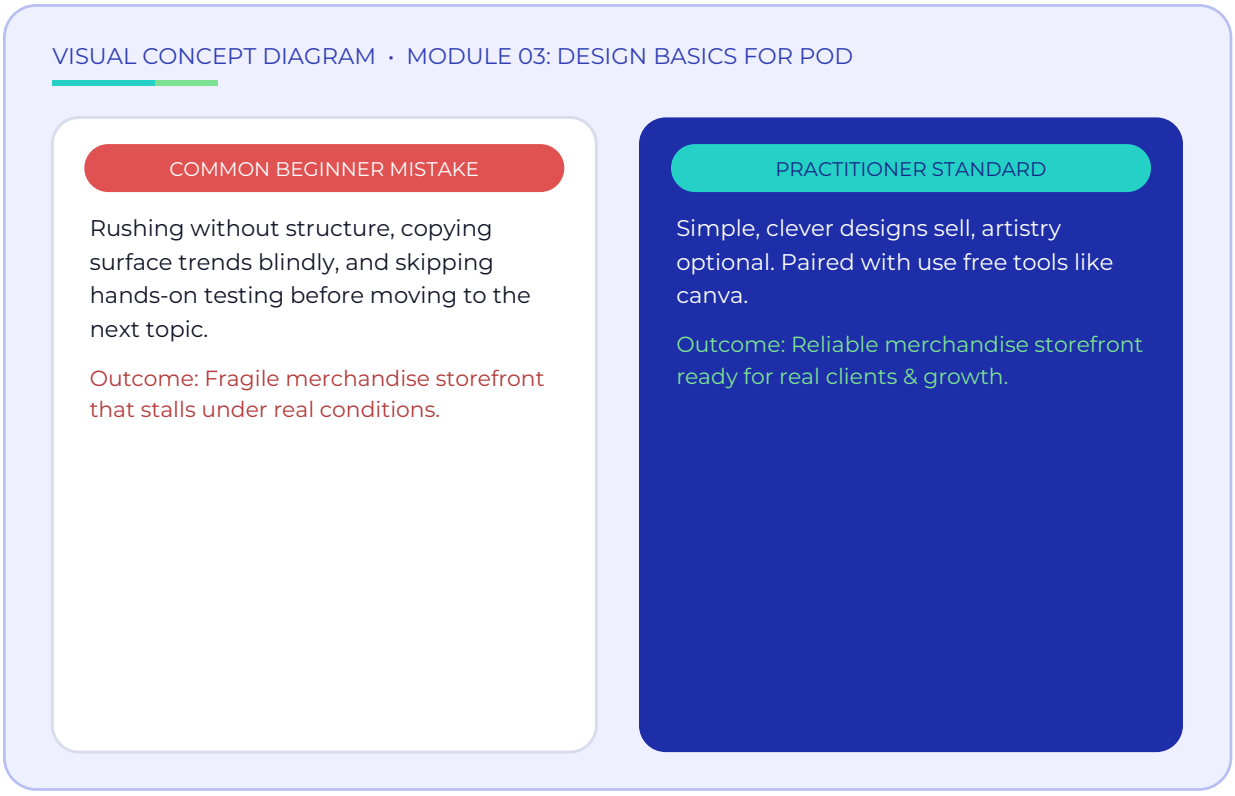
2.1 Design basics for POD

You do not need to be a trained artist. Many top-selling POD designs are simple: a clever phrase in a nice font, clean typography, or a minimal graphic. Free and low-cost tools like Canva let anyone create sellable designs. What matters is a clear idea, readable text, and a look that suits the niche and product.

Learn the technical basics: designs need to be high resolution, usually with a transparent background, and sized correctly for the product. A great idea ruined by a blurry or badly-placed image will not sell. Keep designs clean and legible even as a small thumbnail, because that is how buyers first see them.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *design basics for pod* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real merchandise storefront. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that simple, clever designs sell, artistry optional., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.

VISUAL CONCEPT DIAGRAM · MODULE 03: DESIGN BASICS FOR POD



MODULE 03 | FIELD BRIEF

Focus Skill:
Design basics for POD

Core Rule:
Simple, clever designs sell, artistry optional.

Target Output:
Working merchandise storefront

MODULE 03 | WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
One of the best-selling POD styles is just bold text: a relatable phrase in a strong font on a plain background. No drawing skill needed, just wit, clean typography and the right niche.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Print on Demand workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 03

Your Practical Task: Create three simple text-based designs in Canva for your chosen niche. Export them high-resolution with a transparent background.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 03 Key Takeaways

01

Simple, clever designs sell, artistry optional.

02

Use free tools like Canva.

03

High resolution and correct sizing are essential.

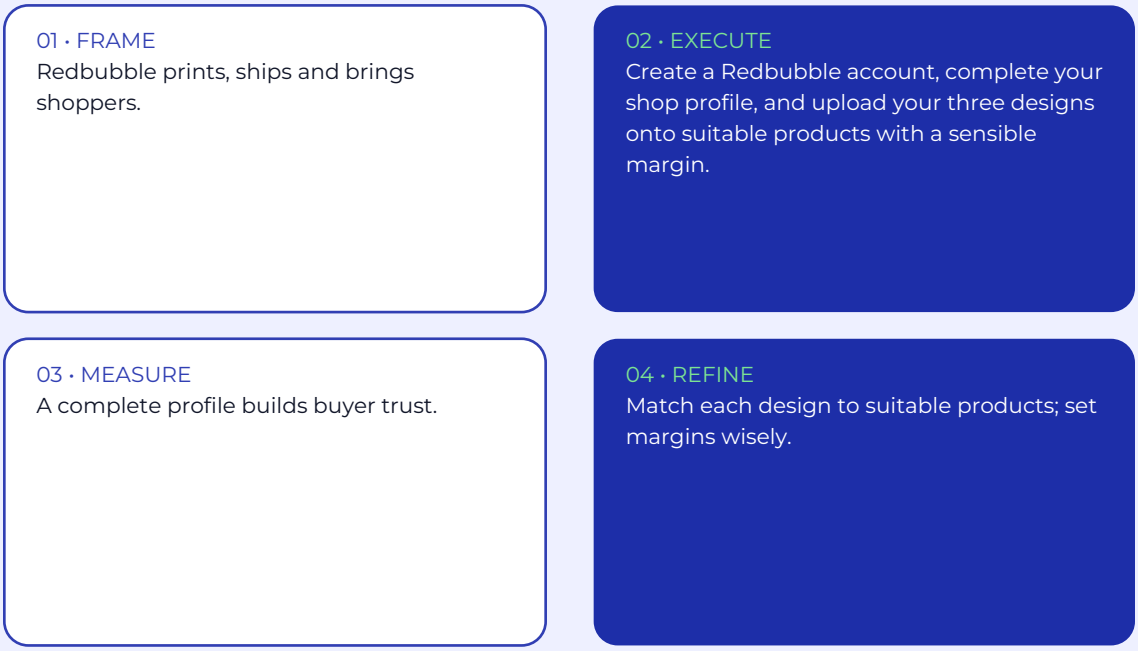
2.2 Setting up on Redbubble

Redbubble is beginner-friendly because it hosts your products, prints, ships and even brings shoppers through its own marketplace search. You create a free account, set up your shop, and upload designs, placing each on the products you choose. This is the fastest way to get your first sales without needing your own website or traffic.

Fill your profile and shop properly, a clear name, banner and bio build trust. Enable the products that suit each design (a wordy joke works on shirts and mugs; a detailed graphic suits posters). Set your profit margin sensibly: too high and nothing sells, too low and it is not worth it. You can adjust as you learn.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *setting up on redbubble* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real merchandise storefront. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that redbubble prints, ships and brings shoppers., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.

VISUAL CONCEPT DIAGRAM · MODULE 04: SETTING UP ON REDBUBBLE



MODULE 04 | FIELD BRIEF

Focus Skill:
Setting up on Redbubble

Core Rule:
Redbubble prints, ships and brings shoppers.

Target Output:
Working merchandise storefront

MODULE 04 | WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A learner set up a Redbubble shop in an afternoon, uploaded ten designs across shirts and stickers, and made her first international sale within weeks, purely from Redbubble's own search traffic, with no outside marketing.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Print on Demand workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 04

Your Practical Task: Create a Redbubble account, complete your shop profile, and upload your three designs onto suitable products with a sensible margin.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 04 Key Takeaways

01

Redbubble prints, ships and brings shoppers.

02

A complete profile builds buyer trust.

03

Match each design to suitable products; set margins wisely.



03
Execution & Applied Mastery

Module 05: Creating listings that sell | Module 06: Marketing your store

MODULE 05 · PART 1

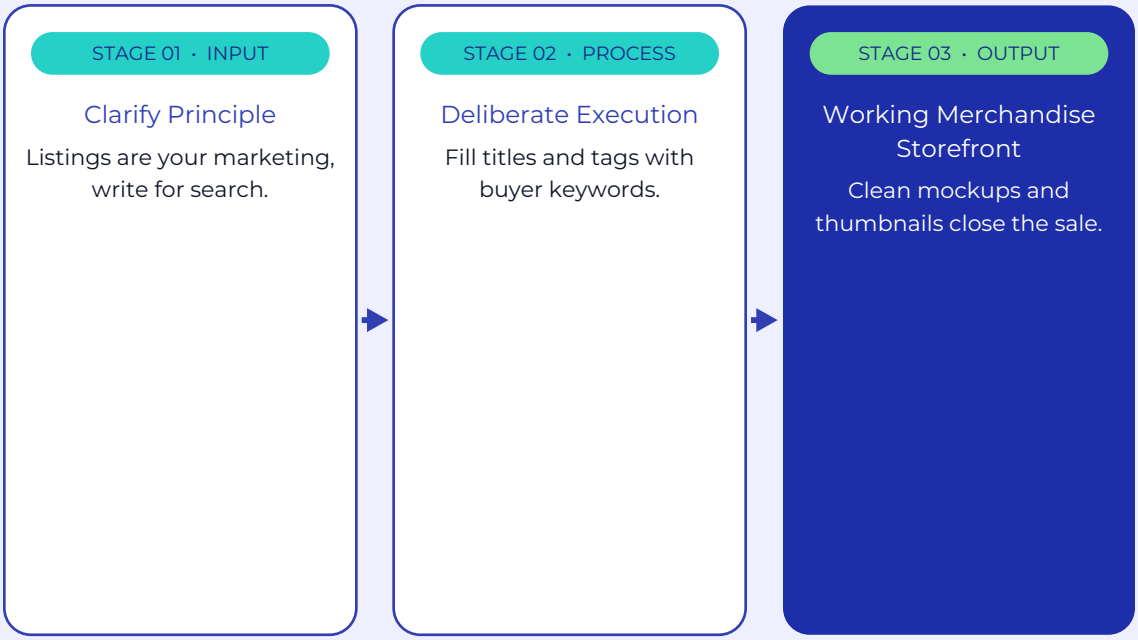
3.1 Creating listings that sell

On marketplaces, most sales come from search, so your listing text is your marketing. Use clear, keyword-rich titles and tags that describe exactly what the design is and who it is for ('funny nurse mug gift for night shift'). Think like the buyer: what words would they type? Fill every tag with relevant terms, this is how the platform matches you to shoppers.

Good visuals close the sale. Use the platform's mockups so buyers see the design on a real-looking product, and make sure it looks great as a small thumbnail. A strong title, complete tags and clean mockups turn a hidden design into a findable, buyable product.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *creating listings that sell* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real merchandise storefront. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that listings are your marketing, write for search., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.

VISUAL CONCEPT DIAGRAM · MODULE 05: CREATING LISTINGS THAT SELL



MODULE 05 | FIELD BRIEF

Focus Skill:
Creating listings that sell

Core Rule:
Listings are your marketing, write for search.

Target Output:
Working merchandise storefront

MODULE 05 | WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
Two identical designs, different listings. The one with a vague title 'Cool Design 1' never sold; the one titled and tagged 'Funny Teacher Appreciation Gift T-Shirt' started selling, because buyers could finally find it.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Print on Demand workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 05

Your Practical Task: Write a keyword-rich title and a full set of tags for each of your designs, imagining the exact words your buyer would search.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 05 Key Takeaways

01

Listings are your marketing, write for search.

02

Fill titles and tags with buyer keywords.

03

Clean mockups and thumbnails close the sale.

3.2 Marketing your store

Marketplace search alone can bring sales, but marketing multiplies them. Share your designs on social media where your niche gathers, a nurses' design in nursing groups, a gym design on fitness pages. Content showing the products in real life (photos, short videos) drives clicks. You become your own free advertising channel.

Building a small audience around your niche pays long-term: an Instagram or TikTok page for your design theme brings repeat buyers and lets you launch new designs to warm fans. Marketing is also feedback, watch which designs people react to and make more like them. Selling and listening go together.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *marketing your store* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real merchandise storefront. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that marketing multiplies marketplace sales., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.



MODULE 06 | FIELD BRIEF

Focus Skill:
Marketing your store

Core Rule:
Marketing multiplies marketplace sales.

Target Output:
Working merchandise storefront

MODULE 06 | WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A creator posted her hiking-themed designs in outdoor Facebook groups and on a small Instagram page. Those free posts, not the marketplace search, became her biggest source of sales, and her followers requested new designs she then made and sold.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Print on Demand workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 06

Your Practical Task: Share one of your designs in a relevant online community or on a niche social page. Note any clicks, feedback or sales it brings.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 06 Key Takeaways

01

Marketing multiplies marketplace sales.

02

Share where your niche already gathers.

03

A niche audience brings repeat buyers and ideas.



04
Scaling, Capstone & Excellence

Module 07: Scaling your income | Module 08: Launch your POD store

MODULE 07 · PART 1

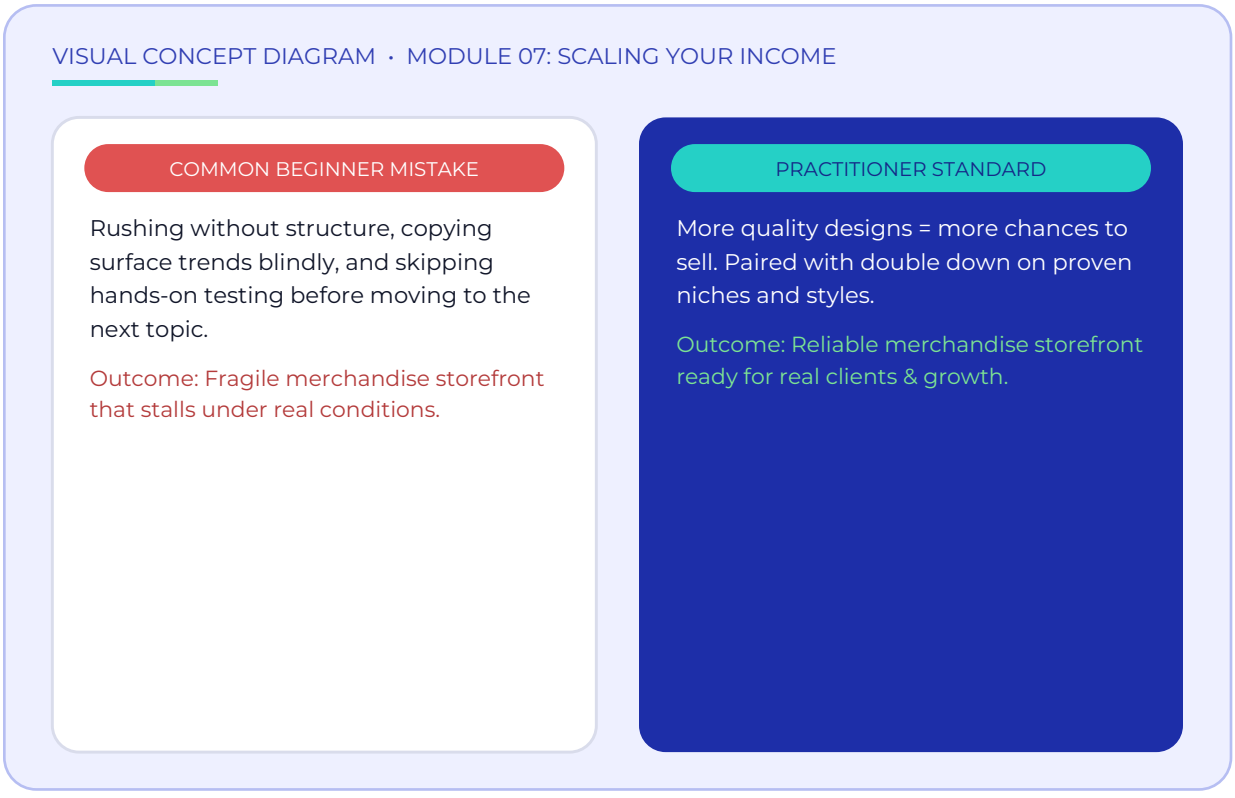
4.1 Scaling your income

POD is a numbers game: more good designs across more products and niches means more chances to be found and bought. Once you know what sells, batch-create designs in your winning styles and niches. Many part-time POD sellers grow simply by consistently uploading, keeping the winners, and dropping the duds.

Scale smart, not just big. Double down on your best-performing niches and design styles rather than spreading thin. Consider expanding to other platforms (some let you sell on your own store or via Etsy) once you have proven designs. Reinvest a little time or money into better design tools as your income grows.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *scaling your income* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real merchandise storefront. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that more quality designs = more chances to sell., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.

VISUAL CONCEPT DIAGRAM · MODULE 07: SCALING YOUR INCOME



MODULE 07 | FIELD BRIEF

Focus Skill:
Scaling your income

Core Rule:
More quality designs = more chances to sell.

Target Output:
Working merchandise storefront

MODULE 07 | WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A seller noticed that of her 50 designs, five made most of the sales, all in one niche and style. She made twenty more like those five, and her income climbed, because she followed the data instead of her guesses.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Print on Demand workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 07

Your Practical Task: Once you have some sales, identify your best niche/style. Create five new designs in that exact lane and publish them.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 07 Key Takeaways

01

More quality designs = more chances to sell.

02

Double down on proven niches and styles.

03

Follow the data, not your guesses.

4.2 Launch your POD store

Your final project is a live store with a real set of designs, enough to look established and give the platform's search something to work with. Do not wait for perfect designs; publish a solid batch, then keep adding. A live store that exists and sells beats a perfect one still in your imagination.

Then run the loop that builds real income: create, list well, market a little, watch the data, and make more of what works. POD rewards patience and consistency over months, not days. Keep uploading, keep learning from sales, and the passive income slowly compounds as your catalogue grows.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *launch your pod store* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real merchandise storefront. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that launch with a solid batch, then keep adding., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.

VISUAL CONCEPT DIAGRAM · MODULE 08: LAUNCH YOUR POD STORE



MODULE 08 | FIELD BRIEF

Focus Skill:
Launch your POD store

Core Rule:
Launch with a solid batch, then keep adding.

Target Output:
Working merchandise storefront

MODULE 08 | WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A learner launched with fifteen designs and committed to adding five a week. Sales were quiet for a month, then steadily grew as her catalogue and best-sellers built up, the classic POD curve for those who don't quit early.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Print on Demand workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 08

Your Practical Task: Launch your store with at least ten designs across suitable products. Commit to adding a few new designs each week for the next month.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 08 Key Takeaways

01

Launch with a solid batch, then keep adding.

02

Run the create-list-market-review loop.

03

POD rewards patience and a growing catalogue.

5.1 Complete 8-Module Practice & Competency Matrix

Review every module in Print on Demand using the table below. Check off each module only after you have completed its hands-on assignment and verified your work against the core principle.

Module	Focus Topic	Core Principle	Workbook Check
Module 01	Introduction to print on demand	No stock, no shipping, the platform fulfils orders.	Completed [ ]
Module 02	Choosing your niche	Specific niches sell; generic designs get lost.	Completed [ ]
Module 03	Design basics for POD	Simple, clever designs sell, artistry optional.	Completed [ ]
Module 04	Setting up on Redbubble	Redbubble prints, ships and brings shoppers.	Completed [ ]
Module 05	Creating listings that sell	Listings are your marketing, write for search.	Completed [ ]
Module 06	Marketing your store	Marketing multiplies marketplace sales.	Completed [ ]
Module 07	Scaling your income	More quality designs = more chances to sell.	Completed [ ]
Module 08	Launch your POD store	Launch with a solid batch, then keep adding.	Completed [ ]

CAPSTONE PORTFOLIO STANDARD

Before graduating from this handbook, combine all eight modules into one finished, shareable merchandise storefront: *Launch your store with at least ten designs across suitable products. Commit to adding a few new designs each week for the next month.* When ready for mentor feedback, email your work to chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com.

5.2 Applied Fellowship Case Reflections

Real transformation happens when learners turn theory into consistent service. Reflect on these cohort case highlights from across East Africa as you prepare your own project:

"A designer uploads one funny slogan design and places it on shirts, mugs and stickers. Over months, with no stock and no shipping on her side, those listings quietly sell to buyers around the world while she creates more."

Cohort Case Reflection | Starting Strong in Module 01

STAGE 01

01

STAGE 02

02

"A learner set up a Redbubble shop in an afternoon, uploaded ten designs across shirts and stickers, and made her first international sale within weeks, purely from Redbubble's own search traffic, with no outside marketing."

Mid-Course Breakthrough | Applying Strategy in Module 04

"A learner launched with fifteen designs and committed to adding five a week. Sales were quiet for a month, then steadily grew as her catalogue and best-sellers built up, the classic POD curve for those who don't quit early."

Capstone Completion | Shipping Real Work in Module 08

STAGE 03

03

Stewardship Principle: "Whatever your hand finds to do, do it with excellence, integrity, and faithfulness so your skill becomes a blessing to many."

06 90-Day Action Roadmap

True mastery in Print on Demand is measured by what you build, ship, and steward after finishing the lessons. Follow this structured 90-day implementation plan developed by CHRISCO Youth Aflame (under CHRISCO Fellowship of Churches) to turn study into fruitfulness.

6.1 Four-Stage Post-Course Milestones

01

Days 1 to 14: Foundation Sprint

Complete Modules 1 to 4 labs and document your baseline specimen in Print on Demand.

02

Days 15 to 30: First Live Output

Complete Modules 5 to 8 and ship your first real capstone deliverable: Launch your store with at least ten designs across suitable products. Commit to adding a few new designs each week for the next month.

03

Days 31 to 60: Feedback & Iteration

Share your work with a mentor, peer, or real client/community audience and refine weak points.

04

Days 61 to 90: Service & Multiplication

Use your skill to serve your church, business, or clients faithfully and mentor one younger learner.

Follow-Up Stage	CHRISCO Support Channel	Contact & Cadence
Workbook Review	CHRISCO Digital Academy Desk	chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com
Capstone Submission	CHRISCO Youth Aflame Mentors	shambetz@gmail.com
Peer Accountability	CHRISCO Fellowship Study Hubs	Monthly Cohort Check-In

CHRISCO Youth Aflame
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Equipping Youth, Elevating Purpose

CHRISCO Youth Aflame
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Official 28-Page Illustrated Course E-Book for Print on Demand (Design & Digital Commerce Track).
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